

Business assets, supporting assets and DICT needs

Giving a vocabulary to what the map must protect

Session objectives

By the end of this tutorial:

- **Define** business asset and supporting asset in the exact terms of the French reference method, and connect the two notions without confusing them
- **Translate** a business asset into security needs: availability, integrity, confidentiality, traceability, the famous DICT
- **Rate** these needs in relative position, without false precision, as the guide recommends
- **Assemble** for the MERIDIAN subsidiaries the exact material to be entered into the tool in the afternoon

Prerequisites

- This morning's lecture: the mapping, its stakes, its six views; the business view is precisely where this tutorial's notions live.
- The CISO's briefing: the inventory and critical assets; this tutorial gives "critical" a finer vocabulary.
- The MERIDIAN case from session 1: the processes and gaps per subsidiary, reused as they are.

The missing presentation: four notions, in the order they chain together

A quarter of an hour of vocabulary before handling anything, and this vocabulary is that of ANSSI's EBIOS Risk Manager guide, version 1.5, September 2024, whose risk assessment method arrives in sessions 5 and 7. Today the session borrows only its glossary, because mapping and risk analysis share these words, and learning them once is enough.

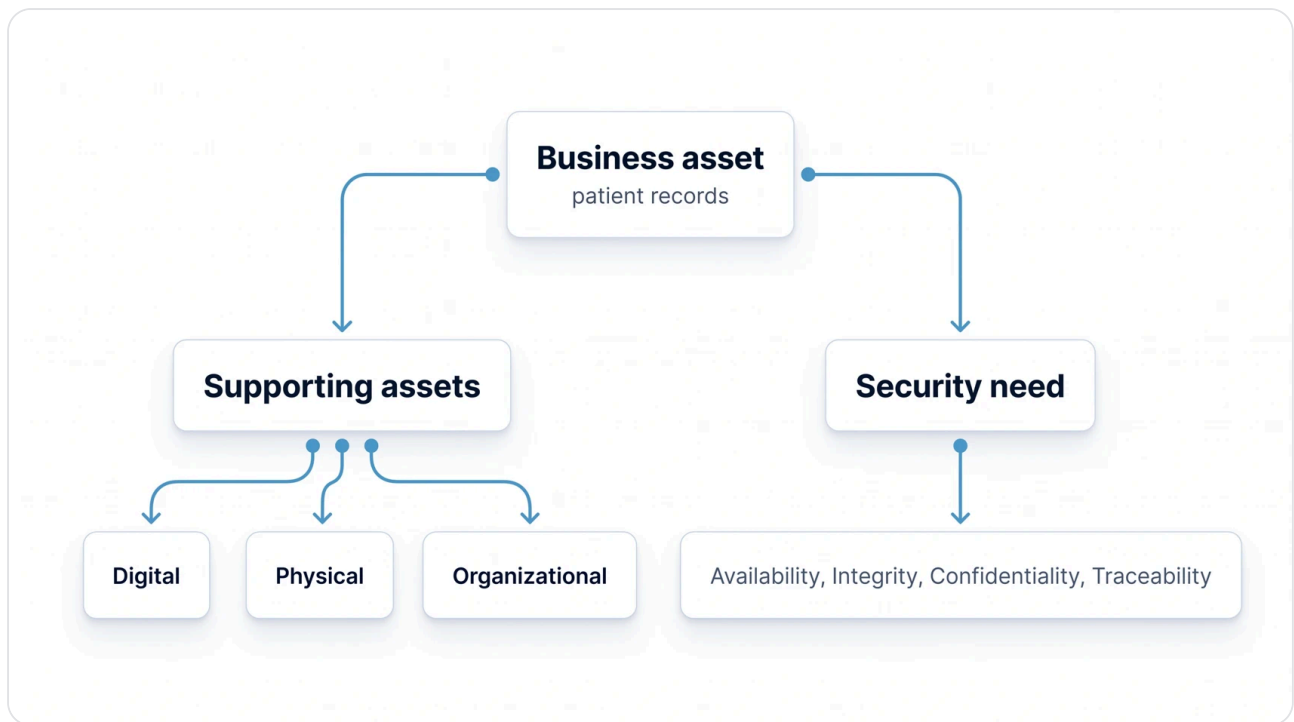
The problem this vocabulary solves: "critical asset", the morning's notion, mixes two questions the method separates. What matters for the mission? And what does it rest on technically? As long as the two are not separated, business and technology fight over the same list: the doctor puts "patient records" on it, the administrator puts "the DBMS" on it, and both are right without understanding each other. The method settles it by giving each a word.

The business asset, first, defined by the guide's glossary: « Dans le cadre de l'étude, composante importante pour l'organisation dans l'accomplissement de sa mission. Cela peut être un service, une fonction support, une étape dans un projet et toute information ou savoir-faire associé. Une valeur métier peut être vue comme un élément à protéger. » ("Within the study, an important component for the organization in the accomplishment of its mission. It can be a service, a support function, a stage in a project and any associated information or know-how. A business asset can be seen as an element to protect.") This is the answer to the first question: what matters. The guide gives telling examples of it, an online booking cancellation service, customer information, research results. What the definition does not contain: a single technical word. A business asset is phrased in the language of the business, and a list of business assets that looks like a list of servers has already slipped from one question to the other. A landmark of normative archaeology, because these synonyms run through an entire career: the ISO 27005 standard calls this « biens primaires » ("primary assets"), and the old 2010 EBIOS method said « biens essentiels » ("essential assets").

The supporting asset, next: « Composante du système d'information sur laquelle repose une ou plusieurs valeurs métier. Un bien support peut être de nature numérique, physique ou organisationnelle. » ("A component of the information system on which one or more business assets rest. A supporting asset can be digital, physical or organizational in nature.") This is the answer to the second question: what it rests on. The guide's examples deliberately sweep the three natures: a server, a telephony network, an interconnection gateway, but also a technical room, and even a team or administrators. This breadth matters: a supporting asset is not necessarily a machine, and forgetting organizational supporting assets, the only team that knows a system for example, is exactly the hole diagnosed at Logistique in the morning. The guide also defines the **critical supporting asset**, the one judged highly likely to be targeted by a risk source: an expression to keep in reserve, it will take on its full relief with the scenarios of sessions 5 and 7.

The security need, finally, and this is where the acronym in the title lives: « Propriété de sécurité à garantir pour une valeur métier. Elle traduit un enjeu de sécurité pour la valeur métier. EXEMPLES : disponibilité, intégrité, confidentialité, traçabilité. » ("A security property to be guaranteed for a business asset. It reflects a security stake for the business asset. EXAMPLES: availability, integrity, confidentiality, traceability.") Four properties, four initials: DICT, from the French words. Two points of terminological honesty. On the one hand, DICT is a professional shorthand, convenient and universally understood, but the method's term is « besoin de sécurité », the security need: in a formal dossier, the term is written out in full, the acronym is kept for speech. On the other hand, the ISO 27005 standard says "security objectives" for the same idea; the same family of synonyms as before. What the security need is NOT: a property of the machine. It is the business asset that needs availability or confidentiality, and the supporting asset inherits it; reversing this direction, rating servers instead of rating what they carry, is the most frequent error of the coming exercise.

The complete chain fits on one line, which is also the order of the three exercises: the organization's mission designates its business assets; each business asset expresses its security needs; each business asset rests on supporting assets, which must guarantee those needs. When harm strikes a need of a business asset, unavailability of a service, disclosure of information, the method speaks of a feared event; that notion belongs to session 5, but one exercise already shows what it looks like in real life.



The vocabulary chain, in the order of the three exercises.

One last tool before starting: **rating**. The guide recommends classifying needs as « très importants », « notables » or « négligeables » ("very important", "notable", "negligible"), or on a 3 or 4-level scale, and it specifies the objective: obtaining « une position relative des valeurs métier les unes par rapport aux autres » ("a relative position of the business assets with respect to one another"). Relative position: those two words protect against the exercise's infantile disease, false precision. A 3-level rating the team understands is worth more than a mark out of 100 nobody can justify; what is asked is being able to say WHY the availability of freight weighs more than that of the training portal, not producing decimals.

The guide's own running example serves as a model answer key: a biotechnology company, a vaccine manufacturer, whose business assets and supporting assets the guide walks through. It is to be consulted in case of doubt about method: it is the official yardstick for the exercise now conducted on MERIDIAN.

A quick test to separate business asset from supporting asset: "would the business weep over its disappearance, or only the IT department?". Patient records make caregivers weep; the DBMS hosting them makes only the administrator weep, precisely because it can be replaced by another. The former is a business asset, the latter a supporting asset.

Exercise 1: the business assets of MERIDIAN Santé

The Santé subsidiary operates four care facilities; patient record management there has been a process recognized as critical since session 1, its health database management system is identified, and the MERIDIAN dossier's initial audit noted that the laboratory analyzers and imaging consoles share the office IP range, with an identical local administrator account across the fleet.

1. **Identify** between three and five business assets of the subsidiary, phrased in the language of the business, keeping to what the MERIDIAN dossier establishes (hint: think also of information and know-how, not only of services rendered).

2. **Attach** to each business asset its supporting assets, taking care to cover the three possible natures, digital, physical, organizational.

3. **Spot** in the list the supporting asset that the dossier's initial audit makes the most worrying, and justify in one sentence why, using this tutorial's vocabulary and not the audit's.

Suggested time: 12 minutes. Product: a two-column table, business assets and supporting assets, ready to be entered as is this afternoon.

Exercise 2: rating the DICT needs, calibration by facts

Here are four real facts, each illuminating one of the four properties. At the Centre Hospitalier Simone Veil in Cannes, in 2024, ransomware encrypted 15 % of workstations as well as a file server: caregivers deprived of their working tools, that is what "availability" means. In January 2026, the CNIL imposed 42 million euros in fines on Free and Free Mobile after the October 2024 intrusion that had allowed the data of 24 million subscriber contracts to be viewed: confidentiality, and its price. At France Travail, in 2024, it was the data of 43 million people that was potentially exfiltrated: the scale that harm to a single business asset, user data, can take. And according to ENISA, in 2024, 32 % of European operators in the energy sector had none of their critical operational technology processes monitored by a security operations center: traceability absent from an industrial world, the very one in which Logistique's automated warehouses operate.

The work bears on MERIDIAN Logistique this time: the subsidiary operates freight tracking and management, a WMS recognized as critical, six automated warehouses, and the familiar inter-subsiary running thread, the warehouse handheld scanners connected to the Santé subsidiary's inventory management system.

1. **Identify** two business assets of the subsidiary from these elements.

2. **Rate** the four DICT needs of each on the guide's three-level scale, in relative position, with for each rating a one-line justification anchored in the business (hint: what stops the trucks, what falsifies the stocks, what interests a competitor, what prevents understanding an incident after the fact).

3. **Compare** the ratings between the two business assets and against one of the four calibration facts: which rating would deserve revision if the ranking had to be defended before the Logistics Director, and why?
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Suggested time: 15 minutes. The rule of the game: no rating without justification, and no row where everything would be "very important", because a rating that gives nothing up is not a rating.

Exercise 3: the complete chain on the inter-subsidiary running thread

The group's most interesting flow crosses two subsidiaries: Logistique's warehouse handheld scanners feed Santé's inventory management system, on a network the Group CISO had segmented in session 1, dedicated VLAN, inspection firewall, and an emergency supply API requiring TLS 1.3 and MFA.

1. **Walk through** the complete vocabulary chain on this case: the business asset concerned (to whom does it belong, by the way?), its DICT needs rated, and its supporting assets, including the ones that get forgotten.
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2. **Describe**, without using session 5's technical term, what would happen if the integrity of the transmitted stock data were altered: it is the first encounter with what the method will call a feared event.
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3. **Explain** in two sentences why this case justifies a group mapping and not merely four subsidiary mappings.
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Suggested time: 10 minutes. This is the synthesis exercise: it mobilizes the three notions and directly prepares the internal ecosystem view entered in the afternoon.

Answer keys and assessment criteria

Answer key for exercise 1

Defensible business assets for Santé, in the language of the business: patient care (the service rendered), patient records (the information, a business asset in its own right), appointment and admission management (the flow that conditions everything else), and, for those who thought of know-how, the care protocols specific to the facilities. The health DBMS has no place in that column: it is the digital supporting asset of the patient records. Around it: the laboratory analyzers and imaging consoles (digital and physical supporting assets of patient care), the technical rooms of the four facilities (physical nature), and the health IS administration teams (organizational nature). The most worrying supporting asset in light of the dossier's initial audit: the analyzers and consoles, because they carry a business asset with the highest availability need while sharing the office IP range and a common administrator account; in the tutorial's vocabulary, a supporting asset whose weakness directly exposes the security needs of the subsidiary's most critical business asset.

Answer key for exercise 2

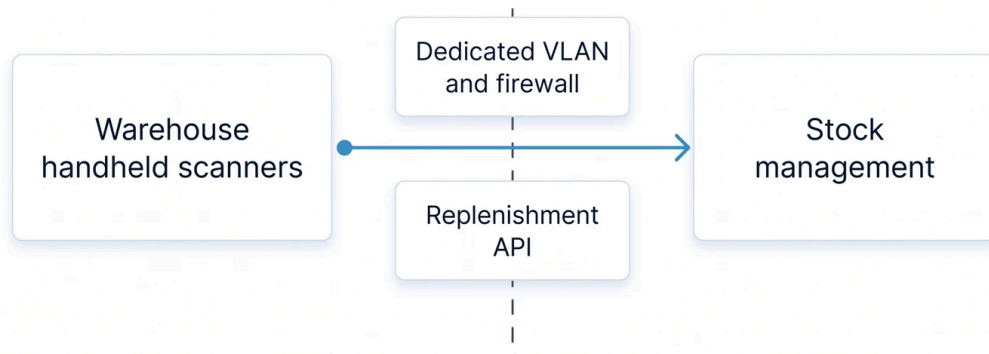
Two business assets stood out: freight traceability (the information that makes the service valuable) and the execution of logistics flows (the service itself, carried by the WMS and the automated warehouses). A defensible rating, on three levels: for the execution of flows, availability very important (a WMS outage stops the trucks, the risk posed as early as session 1), integrity very important (falsified stocks ship the wrong product to the wrong place, and the running thread feeds the Santé subsidiary), confidentiality notable (volumes and customers interest a competitor, but nothing comparable to health data), traceability notable to very important depending on the argument retained, and that is where the ENISA fact was meant to serve: in an industrial environment without monitoring of critical processes, one can neither detect nor understand; a serious candidate for a rating revision before the Logistics Director. For freight traceability, integrity comes before everything: false traceability is worse than none, it earns misplaced trust. The essence of the answer key is not the exact grid: it is that every rating has a business justification and that the two assets are NOT rated identically, otherwise the relative position has ranked nothing.

Answer key for exercise 3

The business asset is the Santé subsidiary's emergency supply, and the ownership question was not rhetorical: the asset belongs to Santé (it is its care mission that requires being supplied), while most of the supporting assets belong to Logistique, handheld scanners, the inventory management system on the Santé side, the supply API, the dedicated VLAN, the inspection firewall, not forgetting the warehouse operations teams, an organizational supporting asset. This dissociation, business asset at one subsidiary, supporting assets at the other, is THE answer to question 3: a per-subsubsidiary mapping would show Santé an asset without supports and Logistique supports without an asset; only the group map reveals the dependency, and that is precisely the inter-subsubsidiary arbitrator role entrusted to the Group CISO in session 1. For question 2: altered stock data would cause ordering too much, too little or to the wrong place, to the point of depriving a care facility of an urgent supply on the strength of a phantom stock; harm to the integrity of a business asset, with cascading consequences. That is, described with today's words, what session 5 will call a feared event and will teach how to rate in severity.

MERIDIAN Logistique

MERIDIAN Santé



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Assessment criteria

CRITERION	INSUFFICIENT	EXPECTED	EXCELLENT
Business assets	Servers and applications in the business column	Three to five assets in business language, grounded in the MERIDIAN dossier	Same, including a piece of information or know-how, not only services
Supporting assets	Machines only	The three natures represented, explicit attachments	Same, with a relevant organizational supporting asset identified without a hint
DICT rating	Everything "very important", or scores without justification	Relative position owned, one business justification per rating	Same, with an explicit trade-off revisited in light of a calibration fact
Complete chain	The three notions treated separately	The chain walked through on the running thread, ownership of the business asset established	Same, with the group map argument phrased in terms of inter-subsidiary dependency
Vocabulary	DICT presented as an official standard	The exact terms, the acronym given as a working alias	Same, with the ISO 27005 correspondences placed judiciously